

# EVIDENCE OF COVERAGE

SilverShield Health Plans — All Plan Tiers | Plan Year 2025

## SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION AND DEFINITIONS

### 1.1 About This Document

This Evidence of Coverage (EOC) describes the health care benefits available under your SilverShield Health Plan. It explains your rights and responsibilities as a member and the terms and conditions of your coverage. Please read this document carefully and keep it in a safe place for future reference. If there is any conflict between this EOC and your Certificate of Coverage, the Certificate of Coverage controls.

### 1.2 Key Definitions

**ALLOWED AMOUNT:** The maximum amount SilverShield will pay for a covered service. Also called 'eligible expense,' 'payment allowance,' or 'negotiated rate.'

**COINSURANCE:** Your share of the costs of a covered health care service, calculated as a percentage of the allowed amount for the service. For example, if the allowed amount for a service is \$100 and your coinsurance is 20%, your coinsurance would be \$20.

**COPAYMENT (COPAY):** A fixed amount you pay for a covered health care service, usually when you receive the service. The amount can vary by the type of covered health care service.

**DEDUCTIBLE:** The amount you owe for health care services your plan covers before your insurance plan begins to pay.

**IN-NETWORK PROVIDER:** A provider who has a contract with SilverShield to provide services to members. In-network providers have agreed to accept the allowed amount as payment in full.

**OUT-OF-NETWORK PROVIDER:** A provider who does not have a contract with SilverShield. You may pay more for services from out-of-network providers.

**OUT-OF-POCKET MAXIMUM:** The most you pay during a plan year before SilverShield begins to pay 100% of the allowed amount. This limit never includes your premium, balance-billed charges, or health care plan doesn't cover.

**PREAUTHORIZATION:** Approval from SilverShield that you must get before certain services or supplies are covered under your plan. Also called 'prior authorization.'

### 1.3 Member Identification Card

Your member ID card is your key to accessing SilverShield benefits. Present it every time you seek care. The card shows your Member ID number, Group number, plan type, and copay information. If you lose your card, you can print a replacement at [silvershieldhealthplans.com](https://silvershieldhealthplans.com) or call Member Services at 1-800-555-0100.

## SECTION 2: ELIGIBILITY AND ENROLLMENT

### 2.1 Who Is Eligible

You are eligible for SilverShield coverage if you are: (a) An employee of a participating employer group who meets the employer's eligibility requirements; (b) A dependent of an eligible employee, including: lawful spouse or domestic partner; children under age 26 (regardless of marital or student status); disabled children of any age who are incapable of self-support due to mental or physical disability that began before age 26.

### 2.2 Enrollment Periods

**INITIAL ENROLLMENT:** You must enroll within 30 days of becoming eligible. If you miss the initial enrollment period, you must wait for the next Open Enrollment Period unless you qualify for a Special Enrollment Period.

**OPEN ENROLLMENT:** Occurs annually, typically in November for January 1 coverage effective dates. Specific dates are communicated by your employer.

**SPECIAL ENROLLMENT PERIODS:** You may enroll outside Open Enrollment if you experience a qualifying life event, including: loss of other coverage, marriage, divorce, birth or adoption of a child, or change in employment status.

### 2.3 Effective Date of Coverage

Coverage typically begins on the first day of the month following your enrollment date, unless your employer specifies otherwise. Your employer's plan document governs the specific effective date rules.

## 2.4 Continuation of Coverage (COBRA)

If you lose coverage due to a qualifying event (such as termination of employment, reduction in hours, or divorce), you may have the right to continue your coverage for a limited time under COBRA. You must elect COBRA within 60 days of losing coverage. The monthly COBRA premium is the full plan cost plus a 2% administrative fee. Contact your employer's HR department or call SilverShield COBRA Services at 1-800-555-0200.

## SECTION 3: ACCESSING CARE

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### 3.1 Finding In-Network Providers

Use the SilverShield Provider Directory at [silvershieldhealthplans.com](https://silvershieldhealthplans.com) to find in-network physicians, specialists, hospitals, urgent care centers, labs, and other facilities. You may also call Member Services at 1-800-555-0100 for assistance finding a provider. Always confirm a provider's network status before scheduling an appointment, as directory information may change.

### 3.2 Primary Care Physicians

You do not need to select a Primary Care Physician (PCP) under the SilverShield PPO plan. However, having a regular PCP is strongly encouraged for continuity of care and care coordination. A PCP can provide referrals and help coordinate specialist care, which may result in better health outcomes.

### 3.3 Specialist Access

You do not need a referral to see an in-network specialist. However, certain specialist services and procedures require prior authorization. See Section 5 for the complete Prior Authorization requirements list.

### 3.4 Emergency Care

Emergency care is covered at in-network benefit levels regardless of whether you receive care from an in-network or out-of-network provider. An emergency medical condition is one that a reasonable person would believe requires immediate medical attention to prevent serious impairment to bodily functions, organs, or parts. Emergency room copayments are waived if you are admitted to the hospital directly from the emergency room.

### 3.5 Urgent Care

Urgent care centers are appropriate for conditions that are not life-threatening but require prompt medical attention, such as minor fractures, sprains, earaches, sore throats, fever, and minor lacerations. Always use in-network urgent care centers to receive the lowest cost-sharing. A list of in-network urgent care centers is available in the Provider Directory.

### 3.6 Telehealth Services

SilverShield covers telehealth visits for eligible services. Telehealth visits with in-network providers are covered at the same cost-sharing as in-person visits. To access telehealth services, use the SilverShield Virtual Care portal at [silvershieldhealthplans.com/virtualcare](https://silvershieldhealthplans.com/virtualcare) or call 1-800-555-0300. Telehealth is available 24/7 for general medical, behavioral health, and dermatology services.

## SECTION 4: COVERED SERVICES

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### 4.1 Preventive Care

SilverShield covers preventive care services at no cost to you (no deductible, copay, or coinsurance) when received from an in-network provider. Covered preventive services include, but are not limited to: Annual physical examinations; Blood pressure, cholesterol, and diabetes screenings; Cancer screenings (mammogram, colonoscopy, cervical cancer); Immunizations recommended by the Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices (ACIP); Well-child visits and developmental screenings; Tobacco cessation counseling; Depression screening; Obesity counseling. Note: If a preventive visit also includes diagnosis or treatment of an existing condition, cost-sharing may apply to the portion of the visit that is not preventive.

## 4.2 Physician Office Services

Covered office visit services include: Evaluation and management services; Minor procedures performed in the office; Allergy testing and immunotherapy; Injections and infusions; Office-based laboratory tests; Office-based X-rays. Your cost-sharing for office visits depends on your plan tier and is shown in your Summary of Benefits and Coverage (SBC).

## 4.3 Hospital Services

**INPATIENT CARE:** SilverShield covers medically necessary inpatient hospital stays. Prior authorization is required for non-emergency inpatient admissions. Cost-sharing is the coinsurance percentage after the deductible is met, as shown in your SBC. A maximum of 365 inpatient days per plan year is covered.

**OUTPATIENT SERVICES:** Outpatient hospital services include observation stays, outpatient surgery, chemotherapy, radiation therapy, dialysis, and outpatient diagnostic procedures. Prior authorization may be required for certain outpatient procedures.

**EMERGENCY CARE:** Emergency room visits are covered as described in Section 3.4. The ER copay is waived if you are admitted as an inpatient directly from the ER.

## 4.4 Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Services

SilverShield provides mental health and substance use disorder benefits that are at parity with medical and surgical benefits, as required by the Mental Health Parity and Addiction Equity Act (MHPAEA). Covered services include: Inpatient psychiatric care; Outpatient individual and group therapy; Intensive outpatient programs (IOP); Partial hospitalization programs (PHP); Medication management; Applied behavior analysis (ABA) for autism spectrum disorder (unlimited visits); Substance use disorder treatment including detoxification and rehabilitation. Prior authorization is required for inpatient psychiatric admissions and residential treatment.

## 4.5 Prescription Drugs

SilverShield covers prescription drugs through its formulary (drug list). Drugs are classified into four tiers:

**TIER 1 – GENERIC DRUGS:** Lower-cost generic medications. Available at the lowest copay. **TIER 2 – PREFERRED BRAND DRUGS:** Brand-name drugs preferred by SilverShield based on clinical effectiveness and cost. Available at a mid-level copay. **TIER 3 – NON-PREFERRED BRAND DRUGS:** Brand-name drugs that have a generic or preferred brand alternative. Available at a higher copay. **TIER 4 – SPECIALTY DRUGS:** High-cost drugs typically used to treat complex, chronic, or rare conditions. Subject to coinsurance after deductible.

Prescriptions may be filled at any in-network retail pharmacy or through SilverShield Mail Order Pharmacy for a 90-day supply. Step therapy may be required for certain drugs (see formulary). Some drugs require prior authorization.

## 4.6 Rehabilitation and Habilitation Services

SilverShield covers medically necessary rehabilitation services, subject to visit limits:

Physical Therapy: 30 visits per plan year Occupational Therapy: 30 visits per plan year Speech Therapy: 30 visits per plan year Cardiac Rehabilitation: Unlimited (medically necessary) Pulmonary Rehabilitation: Unlimited (medically necessary)

Habilitation services (to help maintain or prevent decline) for members with developmental disabilities are covered at the same limits. Additional visits may be authorized if medically necessary documentation is provided.

# SECTION 5: EXCLUSIONS AND LIMITATIONS

## 5.1 General Exclusions

The following services and supplies are NOT covered under your SilverShield plan:

(a) Services not medically necessary as determined by SilverShield Medical Director (b) Cosmetic surgery and procedures, except for reconstructive surgery required due to injury, disease, or congenital defect (c) Experimental or investigational treatments, procedures, drugs, or devices (d) Dental care for adults (preventive dental is not covered; orthodontia is not covered) (e) Hearing aids and hearing examinations for the purpose of fitting hearing aids (f) Long-term care, custodial care, or domiciliary care (g) Services performed outside the United States (emergency care exception applies) (h) Injuries resulting from acts of war (i) Workers' compensation-eligible conditions (j) Infertility treatment (diagnostic evaluation is covered; treatment including IVF is not) (k) Weight loss surgery (prior authorization

required; covered only if BMI  $\geq 40$  or  $\geq 35$  with comorbidity) (l) Acupuncture (except when ordered by an in-network physician for a covered medical condition) (m) Routine foot care (diabetic foot care is covered) (n) Non-prescription drugs, vitamins, and dietary supplements (o) Private duty nursing (except as authorized under Home Health Care benefit) (p) Educational or vocational therapy

## 5.2 Coordination of Benefits

If you are covered by more than one health plan, SilverShield will coordinate benefits with the other plan to prevent payment of more than 100% of covered expenses. The order of payment is determined by industry-standard coordination of benefits rules. You must notify SilverShield if you have other health coverage.

## SECTION 6: CLAIMS AND APPEALS

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### 6.1 Filing a Claim

**IN-NETWORK PROVIDERS:** In-network providers will file claims on your behalf. You should not need to file a claim yourself for in-network services.

**OUT-OF-NETWORK PROVIDERS:** For out-of-network services, you may need to file a claim directly with SilverShield. Claims must be submitted within 180 days of the date of service. Submit completed claim forms with itemized bills to: SilverShield Claims Department, P.O. Box 55000, Springfield, IL 62705.

### 6.2 Explanation of Benefits (EOB)

After a claim is processed, SilverShield will send an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) showing: the services that were billed; the amount billed by the provider; the amount covered by SilverShield; the amount you owe. Review your EOB carefully. If you believe there is an error, contact Member Services within 30 days of receiving the EOB.

### 6.3 Appeals Process

**FIRST-LEVEL APPEAL:** If a claim is denied or a service requires prior authorization that is denied, you may file a first-level appeal within 180 days of receiving the denial. Submit a written appeal to: SilverShield Appeals Department, P.O. Box 55100, Springfield, IL 62705. SilverShield will respond within 30 days for non-urgent appeals and 72 hours for urgent/expedited appeals.

**SECOND-LEVEL APPEAL:** If your first-level appeal is denied, you may file a second-level appeal within 60 days of the first-level denial. SilverShield will conduct an independent review.

**EXTERNAL REVIEW:** If your second-level appeal is denied, you have the right to request an independent external review through the Illinois Department of Insurance. Contact information: Illinois DOI, 320 W. Washington St., Springfield, IL 62767.

## SECTION 7: MEMBER RIGHTS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

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### 7.1 Member Rights

As a SilverShield member, you have the right to:

(a) Receive information about SilverShield, its services, its practitioners and providers, and member rights and responsibilities (b) Be treated with respect and recognition of your dignity and your right to privacy (c) Participate with practitioners in making decisions about your health care (d) A candid discussion of appropriate or medically necessary treatment options for your conditions, regardless of cost or benefit coverage (e) Voice complaints or appeals about SilverShield or the care it provides (f) Make recommendations regarding SilverShield's member rights and responsibilities policy (g) Receive a copy of this EOC, your Summary of Benefits and Coverage, and your Certificate of Coverage upon request

### 7.2 Member Responsibilities

As a SilverShield member, you are responsible for:

(a) Providing complete and accurate information to SilverShield and your providers (b) Following the prescribed treatment plan agreed upon with your provider (c) Understanding your health problems and participating in developing treatment goals (d) Notifying SilverShield of any change in your address, name, or family status within 30 days (e) Paying your premiums, copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles on time (f) Obtaining prior authorizations when

required (g) Notifying SilverShield of any other health insurance coverage you have

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